Diagnosis

Tests to measure lung function

- **Spirometry.** This test estimates the narrowing of your bronchial tubes
- **Peak flow.** A peak flow meter is a simple device that measures how hard you can breathe out.
- **Skin testing to identify causative allergens**
- **X-ray chest**

Medical management

- Antibiotics
- Immunotherapy
- Corticosteroids.
- Bronchodialators

Nursing management

- Assess the airway of the patient
- Assess the skin turgor for dehydration
- Patient room should be free of respiratory irritants

Lifestyle and home remedies

Avoid triggers

- Maintain optimal humidity.
- Reduce pet dander.
- Change the bed linen once in a week.
- Cover the nose and mouth during cold season.

Stay healthy

- Exercise regularly.
- Maintain a healthy weight.
- Control heartburn and Gastro Esophageal Reflux disease (GERD).

Alternative medicine

- Breathing exercises.
- Herbal and natural remedies includes black cumin seeds.

Prevention

- Get vaccinated for influenza and pneumonia.
- Avoid asthma triggers



The more ozone you breathe, the greater the likelihood of developing asthma.

2.18 Chronic Obstructive Pulmonary Disease (COPD)

Chronic Obstructive Pulmonary Disease (COPD) is an umbrella term used to describe progressive lung diseases including emphysema and chronic bronchitis.

Definition

COPD is a obstructive lung disease characterized by long-term breathing problems and poor airflow.

Causes

- Cigarette smoking
- Indoor air pollution
- Exposure to fumes from burning wood
- Chronic respiratory infections
- Allergy autoimmunity
- Occupational exposure
- Hereditary and genetic factors
- Alpha-antitrypsin deficiency

Signs and Symptoms

- Dyspnea Shortness of breath,
- Chronic coughing,
- Wheezing,
- Chest tightness
- Production of thick, gelatinus sputum
- Acute or chronic reparatory failure,
- Weight loss,
- Respiratory insufficiency,
- Tachypnea,Fatigue,Peripheral edema

2.18.4 Diagnosis

- Lung (pulmonary) function tests
- Spirometry

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